



Canon PowerShot SX520HS

Zoom into loads of fun

The PowerShot SX520HS is an upgraded model of the SX510 HS with a much higher zoom capability and a larger body.

A bridge camera, the PowerShot SX520 HS has a better 15.9MP CMOS sensor which is a bump from the previous gen and it also has a larger 42x optical zoom lens which offers focal length of 24-1008mm. There is a further 84x digital zoom as well which is, to be honest, overkill and an unnecessary addition. The aperture range is f/3.4 to f/8 on the widest focal length and f/6 to f/8 on the highest focal length. For low light performance, the camera offers an ISO range of 100 to 3200 which is pretty good for low light shots.

The SX520 HS feels a lot like its predecessor but is now a bit larger and a bit heavier. It is still however compact enough to carry around on your vacation if you don't like carrying a bulky DSLR. The camera is all plastic with a matte that offers some grip. The lens however feels stronger as it has a metal ring around it to offer protection. At the back there is a 3-inch display which is the same as the previous gen camera. The back also a bunch of control buttons including a dedicated recording button, an exposure compensation/delete button, a playback button, the menu button and the drive control button. There is also a 5-key D-pad, but Canon has removed the rotating wheel which was present on the last model. Comparing the new SX520 to the SX510, the former feels larger but somehow seems to offer a lesser functionality. However the overall build and quality is quite appealing.

One big feature that we miss is Wi-Fi as Canon has surprisingly removed this feature from the upgrade. Another feature that has been omitted is the slow-mo video mode so now you only get 1080p videos at 30fps.

Performance

The camera has definitely improved on the auto-focusing system and although it isn't the fastest, it is still pretty good in its price-range. You also get a manual focus option which isn't the fastest solution but it's always nice to have. The auto exposure is somehow not very impressive as it tends to overexpose the pictures and we suggest you use any of the manual modes instead. The colours are quite accurate and even noise reduction has been



Price
₹17,995



implemented well. The auto white balance is also quite accurate and the different presets can be useful at times.

The best feature however is the large focal length coverage. With a 42x zoom range, you can shoot far off subjects with ease. In broad daylight, the pictures on the maximum focal length come out looking pretty good. Canon has improved on the auto-focus on the highest focal length which was an issue on the last model.

Video performance is pretty good and the video quality is impressive. Noise is under control but there aren't a lot of controls to tweak the video. The various video resolutions include 480p @30fps, 720p @30fps and 1080p @30fps.

Verdict

If you want a super zoom camera at a budget, then the SX520 HS is a great recommendation. While Canon has upgraded the zoom capability, auto-focus and noise reduction, it has omitted some really useful features like Wi-Fi and the rotating d-pad wheel.

With that said, the camera is actually quite a good investment for everyday shooting. An alternative option could be the Nikon Coolpix P530.

Kunal Khullar



Features.....	60
Performance.....	80
Value	70
Design	70

Specifications

Zoom: 42x optical;
Lens: 24mm wide-angle;
Megapixel: 16; **Sensor:** 1/2.3-inch CMOS; **Max Aperture:** f/3.4 (W), f/6.0 (T); **Sensitivity:** Auto, ISO 100-3200; **LCD Panel:** 3-inch TFT, 461,000 dots;
Video: Up to Full HD @ 30fps; **Weight:** 440g;
Warranty: 2 years

Contact

Canon India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 1-800-180-3366
Email: <http://dgit.in/19plzCn>
Website: <http://www.canon.co.in>